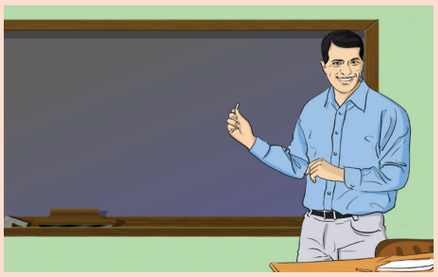
DO YOU KNOW?

ARISTOTLE ON HAPPINESS

Aristotle believed that happiness was the most important thing in life. He taught that one should not waste one's time in the pursuits of pleasure, but should seek happiness instead. According to him, true happiness lay not in material things, but in understanding one's true nature, and regaling one's full potential. In short, happiness depends upon ourselves, and not on the outside world. One of ***Aristotle***'s most famous quotes is

"...happiness is the meaning and the purpose of life, the whole aim and end of human existence..."

CONVERSATION



Student: Sir, we make a mention of Greek Thinkers like ***Plato*** and ***Aristotle*** in our discussion about the study of politics. In the Indian context, who is considered the first political thinker?

Teacher: In the Indian context, ***Thiruvalluvar***, the author of Thirukkural, the ancient legal text, is considered as one of the first political thinker.

Student: Sir! It is very interesting to know that an ancient Tamil literature seems to be the first political manual in India.

Teacher: Though ***Kautilya***, who was the author of Arthasastra, wrote his book in 300BCE that book concentrated more on the Political Economy, while the Thirukkural of ***Thiruvalluvar*** concentrated more on Political governance.

Student: Oh is it! Sir! Will you please say something about Kautilya!

Teacher: With Pleasure! ***Kautilya***, was the chief Minister of Chandra Gupta Mauryia, who ruled a North Indian State about 300 BCE wrote the book Arthasastra, which literally means Artha=wealth and Sastra=knowledge. In short a first literary source on political economy.

Student: Sir! Then what is the contribution of Thiruvalluvar to political science?

Teacher: Thiruvalluvar has given many concepts in Thirukkural regarding king and kingdom which



can be correlated with the contemporary concepts of political science like state, government etc.

Qualities of King: (Kural no: 382 & 383).

i) Courage ii)Liberal hand iii) Wisdom & energy iv) Knowledge v) Taking strong decisions.

What a kingdom should and should not have? (Kural no: 734).

i) Complete cultivation i) Excessive starvation

ii) Virtuous person ii)Irremediable epidemics.

iii) Merchants with inexhaustible wealth iii).Destructive foes.

Components of Kingdom: (Kural no: 381)

i)People ii)Army iii)Resources iv)Ministry v)Friendship vi)Fort

Duties of King:
i) Identifying resources
ii) Collecting revenue
iii) Protecting revenue.
iv) Distribution of revenue.

Student: Oh! It is very much Interesting to know more from you, about our ancient literary sources on Political Science!

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